EMBRYONIC DISC

Within the inner cell mass, an embryonic disc forms. This separates the cell cluster into the amniotic cavity, which develops into a sac that will fill with fluid and fold around to cover the embryo, and the yolk sac, which helps to transport nutrients to the embryo during the second and third weeks. The disc develops three circular sheets called the primary germ layers – ectoderm, mesoderm, and endoderm – from which all body structures will derive.

EARLY DEVELOPMENT

As soon as implantation has taken place in the lining of the uterus, development begins. The embryonic disc forms the three germ layers, and the placenta starts to form from the trophoblast.